Based on the Riese family genealogy and property records, **Thomas (Tom) J. Riese** was the **nephew** of Wallis Richard Riese Sr. (1894–1968). Their relationship and operational overlap during the late 1960s are defined by the following family and business ties:

- **Generation and Lineage:** Wallis Sr. and **Paul Ernest Riese** (Tom's uncle) were likely brothers or first cousins. This makes Tom Riese a member of the younger generation responsible for managing the family's extensive San Francisco and Peninsula "syndicate" of real estate assets.
- **The "Base" at 732 23rd Avenue:** Wallis Sr. lived at this Richmond District address until his death in August 1968. As the primary property manager for the family, **Tom Riese** would have had direct access to and oversight of this property during its probate and transition period throughout 1969—the same year as the Paul Stine murder and the height of the Zodiac's mailing activity in the Richmond.
- **Parallel Migration:** Wallis Sr.'s children, including **Wallis Riese Jr.**, followed the same suburban migration pattern as Tom and Erma Riese, moving from the city to the Peninsula (specifically **San Mateo and San Carlos**) during the 1960s.

While Wallis Sr. represented the elder "owner" generation, Tom Riese acted as the **operational lead**, providing him with the intimate knowledge of the family's vacant units and geographic layouts that align with the Zodiac's suspected movements.